

JSS 1 FRENCH – FIRST TERM

TOPIC 4: ÉPELER UN MOT / ÉCRIRE UN MOT ÉPELÉ

The French Alphabet, Spelling and Writing Dictated Words

1. The French Alphabet (L'alphabet français)

The French alphabet has the same 26 letters as the English alphabet, but the pronunciation of many letters is different. Accents (é, è, ê, à, ù, ç, etc.) are also important.

A B C D E F G H I J K L M
N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

Pronunciation tips: A (ah), B (bay), C (say), D (day), E (euh), F (eff), G (zhay), H (ash), I (ee), J (zhee), K (kah), L (ell), M (emm), N (enn), O (oh), P (pay), Q (ku), R (air), S (ess), T (tay), U (u), V (vay), W (doobluh-vay), X (eeks), Y (ee-grek), Z (zed).

2. Important Accented Letters

é (e acute) – as in *café*
è (e grave) – as in *père*
ê (e circumflex) – as in *être*
à (a grave) – as in *là*
ù (u grave) – as in *où*
ç (c cedilla) – as in *français* (sounds like s)

3. How to Spell a Word (Épeler)

When you spell a word, say each letter clearly:

Comment ça s'écrit ? – How do you spell that?

Ça s'écrit ... – It is spelled ...

Example: Je m'appelle Musa. M-U-S-A.

Example: Mon nom est Okeke. O-K-E-K-E.

4. Spelling Common Names and Words

Practise spelling:

- Your own name and your friends' names
- Nigerian towns: Lagos (L-A-G-O-S), Abuja (A-B-U-J-A), Kano (K-A-N-O)
- Simple words: livre (L-I-V-R-E), stylo (S-T-Y-L-O), école (É-C-O-L-E)

5. Writing Dictated Words (La dictée)

The teacher says a word or short sentence and students write it. Listen carefully for accents and silent letters. In French many final consonants are silent (e.g. grand, petit, français).

6. Practice Exercise

Spell these words aloud and write them:

1. Bonjour
2. Merci
3. École
4. Nigéria
5. Français
6. Votre prénom
7. Votre nom de famille

7. Summary

Know the French alphabet and the sound of each letter. Learn to spell your name and common words. Pay attention to accents when writing. Practise dictation regularly.

End of Topic 4 – Épeler un mot